ASCPi MLS Study Plan (12 Weeks)

Built from your friend's "ASCPI EXAM" Drive folder (24 files). Assumes about 15 study hours a week and a 12-week runway. Stretch or compress the content weeks to fit your real exam date.

1. What the exam looks like

The folder's own content guideline and ASCP's published outline say the MLS(ASCPi) exam is 100 multiple-choice questions in 2 hours 30 minutes, computer adaptive. There is no fixed number you must get right: you pass by scoring above the pass point (scaled score of 400 on a 100 to 999 scale). Question weights by area:

Content area	Share of exam	Priority
Blood Banking	17-22%	High
Chemistry	17-22%	High
Hematology (incl. hemostasis)	17-22%	High
Microbiology	17-22%	High
Urinalysis and Body Fluids	5-10%	Medium
Immunology	5-10%	Medium
Laboratory Operations	5-10%	Medium

The four big areas are about 70% of the exam, so they get about 70% of your time. Check mls_content_guideline.pdf in the folder against ASCP's current website, because the files are dated 2022 to 2023.

2. What is in the folder, and how to use it

Core review books (use all through the plan)

- Clinical Laboratory Science Review: A Bottom Line Approach (Jarreau), 5th ed. Your main spine. The folder has it twice ("bottom line approach ASCP.pdf" is the same 74.8 MB size), so you only need one.
- Board of Certification Study Guide, Enhanced 6th ed. (ASCP BOC). Closest to the real exam style. Use it for questions.
- Medical Laboratory Science Review (Harr). Second-opinion summaries and questions.
- Success in Clinical Laboratory Science Complete Review (Ciulla and Lehman). Large question bank for practice.
- Quick Review Cards for MLS (Polansky). Flash-style revision, mostly for the last 3 weeks.

Subject textbooks (look things up, do not read cover to cover)

- Hematology: Rodak's Hematology; Blood Cells: A Practical Guide.
- Microbiology: Textbook of Diagnostic Microbiology (Mahon and Lehman); WHO Basic Malaria Microscopy.
- Blood Bank: Modern Blood Banking and Transfusion Practices (Harmening).
- Immunology: Clinical Immunology and Serology (Stevens and Miller).
- Urinalysis and Body Fluids: Strasinger (two copies; the "Strasinger and Di Lorenzo" file is likely the newer edition).

Exam and eligibility documents (read in Week 1 only)

mls_content_guideline, mls_imls_reading_list, ascp-international-procedures-book, imls_1_3_training_doc_form, the eligibility comparison and certification comparison charts, foreign-evaluation-agencies, regionally-accredited-college-university, ascp-boc-covid-19-information, BOC-Newsletter-August.

Gaps to know about

- There is no dedicated Chemistry textbook. Cover Chemistry with the Bottom Line, BOC Study Guide, Harr and Ciulla.
- There is no Laboratory Operations text. Use the review books' chapters on safety, QC, management and lab information systems.
- Several documents are from 2022. Confirm eligibility rules and fees on ASCP's site before you apply.

3. Weekly rhythm (about 15 hours)

- 3 sessions of 2 hours: learn the topic (Bottom Line first, textbook only when something is unclear).
- 2 sessions of 1.5 hours: practice questions on that topic (BOC Study Guide, Ciulla, Harr).
- 1 session of 2 hours: mixed review of earlier weeks.
- 1 session of 1 hour: error log. For every missed question write the rule or fact in one line, then re-read the log every weekend.
- 1 day fully off.

4. Week-by-week plan

Week	Focus	Main resources	Weekly goal
1	Orientation and baseline	Content guideline, reading list, eligibility and procedures documents; 50-question mixed baseline from Ciulla or BOC guide	Application and eligibility sorted; know your weakest areas
2	Hematology I: RBC disorders, anemias, indices,	Bottom Line, Rodak, Blood Cells guide	Recognise cells and calculate indices without notes

Week	Focus	Main resources	Weekly goal
	hemoglobinopathies, morphology		
3	Hematology II: WBC disorders, leukemias, hemostasis and coagulation, malaria	Bottom Line, Rodak, WHO Malaria microscopy	Coagulation cascade and PT/aPTT patterns from memory
4	Chemistry I: carbohydrates, proteins, enzymes, lipids, instrumentation	Bottom Line, BOC guide, Harr	Interpret common panels; know methods and interferences
5	Chemistry II: electrolytes, acid-base, endocrine, toxicology, TDM, QC calculations	Bottom Line, BOC guide, Ciulla	Solve acid-base and QC (Westgard) problems
6	Microbiology I: Gram-positives, Gram-negatives, culture media, biochemical ID	Bottom Line, Mahon	Name organism from a short ID set-up
7	Microbiology II: anaerobes, mycobacteria, fungi, parasites, virology, antimicrobial susceptibility	Bottom Line, Mahon, WHO Malaria	Know classic organism and disease pairings
8	Blood Bank I: ABO and Rh, antibody screen and ID, crossmatch	Bottom Line, Harmening	Work antibody panels step by step
9	Blood Bank II: components, HDFN, transfusion reactions, donor requirements; then Immunology	Harmening, Bottom Line, Stevens	Know reaction work-ups; basic immunology and serology tests
10	Urinalysis and Body Fluids, then Laboratory Operations (safety, QC, regulations, LIS, education)	Strasinger, Bottom Line, Harr	Identify crystals and casts; handle QC and safety questions

Week	Focus	Main resources	Weekly goal
11	Mixed practice under exam conditions: two full 100-question sets in 150 minutes, adaptive-style (no going back)	BOC guide, Ciulla, Harr	Review every miss; re-study the two weakest areas
12	Final review and taper	Quick Review Cards, error log, weakest-topic chapters	Light study; sleep; confirm test centre, ID and appointment

5. Rules that make the plan work

- Questions beat re-reading. Start questions in Week 2 and do not wait until you have "finished" a book.
- Do not chase a raw percentage target. The exam is adaptive, so use your trend across mixed practice sets instead.
- If a subject scores below your average two weeks running, borrow 3 hours from a stronger area.
- Keep the small areas (Urinalysis, Immunology, Lab Ops) in the weekly mixed review so they never go cold.
- In the final week, do not start new books.

6. To tailor this plan

Send me your exam date, how many hours you can really study each week, and any area you already know well. I will rebuild the table to match.

Sources

- ASCP BOC MLS content guideline (mls_content_guideline.pdf, from your folder and ASCP's website): https://www.ascp.org/content/docs/default-source/boc-pdfs/boc-us-guidelines/mls_content_guideline.pdf?sfvrsn=12
- Content percentages cross-checked with: https://open-exam-prep.com/study-guides/ascp-mls/practice-strategy-and-remediation/content-percentage-allocation